

# Account and Access Setup Process

This process defines how employee identities, devices, and application permissions are provisioned, validated, and handed off using least-privilege controls.

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## 1.0 Purpose

The account and access setup process exists to ensure new hires receive the tools they need without exposing the company to avoidable security risk. A well-structured onboarding document should explain not just what access is provided, but how approvals work, when elevated permissions are withheld, and how completion is verified before the ticket is closed.

This document supports a production-grade knowledge base by making identity setup, application provisioning, and role-based access predictable, reviewable, and easy to retrieve. It is intentionally specific about who approves what, which systems are considered baseline, and how exceptions are documented.

## 2.0 Scope

The process applies to every new hire account created in the company's identity provider, device management platform, and approved business systems. It also applies to role changes where the employee requires a different access bundle, even if the individual is not newly hired.

The process covers baseline account creation, multi-factor authentication, device policies, role-based application access, verification, exception handling, and closure criteria for onboarding or internal transfer provisioning requests.

- Covers identity creation, MFA enrollment, baseline app access, and role-specific access bundles.
- Requires manager approval for privileged, financial, personnel, or production-facing systems.
- Uses approved ticketing and identity systems as the source of truth for provisioning evidence.

## 3.0 Responsibilities

The responsibilities below define who must act, approve, review, and maintain records so the process can be executed consistently across teams and audit periods.

### 3.1 IT Operations

- Provision baseline accounts and enforce least-privilege controls through approved templates.
- Validate successful authentication, device policy enforcement, and closure evidence before completing the ticket.
- Record exceptions with approver, reason, and expiry date where additional access is granted temporarily.

### 3.2 Managers

- Review role-based access requests for business need and avoid unnecessary over-provisioning.
- Confirm that the resulting access is sufficient for first-week work without exposing unrelated systems.
- Approve privileged or high-risk access only through the designated workflow.

### 3.3 Employees

- Complete MFA enrollment, password manager setup, and account verification promptly.
- Report missing or unexpected access through the onboarding queue rather than sharing credentials or borrowing devices.
- Use approved systems only and follow security requirements from the first login onward.

## 4.0 Provisioning Principles

Provisioning is based on the principle of least privilege, which means a new hire receives only the access required to begin performing their role safely and effectively. This reduces security exposure, limits accidental access to sensitive systems, and creates a cleaner audit trail when roles change over time.

Role templates provide the starting point, but managers remain accountable for validating that the requested bundle matches the real business need. Exceptions should be rare, time-bound, and documented with the same rigor as any other security-relevant access decision.

- Create the employee identity using approved naming and directory conventions.
- Enroll MFA before the first successful login to company-managed systems.
- Apply baseline endpoint, browser, and device security controls before closure.

## 5.0 Standard and Role-Based Access Workflow

Baseline access typically includes email, calendar, chat, HRIS, ticketing, documentation, and password manager access. These systems support the first week of work for nearly every employee and should be provisioned before more specialized applications are considered.

Role-based access is layered on top of baseline access. Engineering roles may require source control, CI visibility, and development environments, while business roles may require CRM, finance, or support tools. Production, financial, and personnel systems remain separately controlled even when a role template exists.

### 5.1 Engineering Access

- Grant source control, issue tracker, CI visibility, and development environment access through the approved template.
- Require separate approval for production consoles, infrastructure administration, or secret-management tools.
- Validate repository or environment membership after provisioning rather than assuming template success.

### 5.2 Business Access

- Grant CRM, analytics, support, finance, or HR systems only when the role requires them.
- Review bundled permissions carefully to avoid granting unnecessary reporting or export privileges.
- Use the access request workflow for any system not included in the standard role template.

## 6.0 Verification, Handoff, and Closure

A provisioning ticket is not complete when accounts are created; it is complete when the employee can authenticate successfully, required controls are active, and the manager confirms that the initial toolset is appropriate. Closing tickets too early creates a false sense of readiness and pushes avoidable work into the first week.

Verification should include login success, MFA completion, password manager access, and confirmation that key systems open as expected. Any missing access should remain visible as an open action with a named owner rather than being handled informally through direct messages or temporary credential sharing.

- Confirm login success and MFA enrollment with the employee.
- Have the manager validate first-week access sufficiency before closure.
- Retain exceptions and unresolved gaps in the queue until the final handoff is complete.

## 7.0 Exceptions and Escalation

Privileged or temporary access exceptions must include a business reason, approver, review date, and removal plan. Verbal approval is not sufficient for high-risk systems because the ticket record is the audit source of truth.

Escalate immediately if identity creation fails, baseline access cannot be provided by day one, or an employee receives unexpected access to restricted systems. These issues may indicate either an onboarding failure or a security control gap.

## 8.0 Records and Review

Provisioning tickets, manager approvals, exception records, and verification evidence must be retained in approved systems so audits can confirm who granted access, why it was granted, and whether the final state matched policy.

IT Operations reviews template accuracy, failed provisioning trends, and exception volume each quarter. Role bundles should be updated when repeated access gaps or over-provisioning patterns are identified.